

recovery. Deleted data has a higher chance of being recovered if disk activity on the drive after deletion has been minimal.

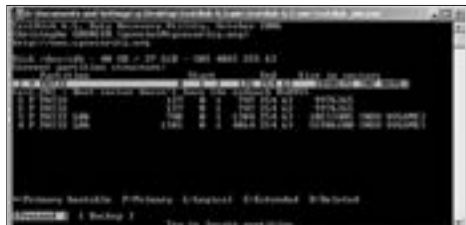
4.6.1 TestDisk

www.cgsecurity.org/testdisk-6.5.win.zip

This little command-line program is an excellent utility for partition table recovery. While the command-line functionality will put off a few, the available options are limited, and the required instructions are presented along with each command. Test disk cannot recover deleted files and folders.



Using TestDisk to check you drives



Once run, it will first analyse the partition table and find if there are any errors. If the partition table is corrupt, it will offer to use the backup to restore the table. Usually a backup of the partition table is stored in another part of the disk, not accessible to users. Problems with the partition table can be rectified in this manner. The more advanced capabilities of TestDisk are beyond the scope of this chapter, but TestDisk can also handle errors where the partition is not properly detected, as is the case when the MBR itself gets deleted. In this scenario, a user can manually enter the hard disk parameters (CHS values), and TestDisk can try to recreate a partition table. The bundled Help file offers adequate guidance to handle some of the situations where TestDisk can be used.